

COURT HEARING CHECKLIST

What to bring with you to your eviction hearing:

- This packet (your filed Answer and all supporting documents)
- Your lease or rental agreement
- Any rent receipts or proof of payment (bank statements, canceled checks)
- Photos or videos of any repair issues (if applicable)
- Any written communication with your landlord (emails, texts, letters)
- Your 7-day repair notice (if you sent one)
- Proof of rental assistance application (if applicable)
- Photo ID
- A pen and paper for taking notes
- A list of the points you want to make to the judge
- Any witnesses (if applicable)
- Your phone (silenced) with important numbers saved

WHAT TO EXPECT AT THE HEARING:

- Arrive early. Find the right courtroom.
- When your case is called, step forward.
- Address the judge as 'Your Honor.'
- Stay calm. Speak clearly. Stick to the facts.
- The landlord (or their lawyer) will speak first.
- When it's your turn, explain your defense briefly.
- Show the judge any evidence you brought.
- The judge may ask questions — answer honestly.
- The judge will make a decision or set another hearing date.